The 2-Minute Rule

STOP › LOOK › ASK › DECIDE

A short pause at the point of work:

- **Before you start**
- **After a break**
- **Handover**
- **Interruption**
- **Change**

Two minutes is a guide. A repeat task takes seconds.

1. **What's different?**
   Anything new, changed, or not as planned?
2. **What could hurt us?**
   Moving parts, power, heat, sparks, solvents, heavy loads, potent product?
3. **Checked or assumed?**
   Checked means you saw or tested it yourself. Assumed means you're guessing.
4. **What if it goes wrong?**
   Where does it go? Who is in the way?

GO You found nothing wrong. Start the job.

FIX IT **Only if** you're trained and authorized, **and** it's a step in your procedure.

STOP & GET HELP **Hands off. Leave it as it is. Call your lead.** No permit yet? Someone else's unfinished work? Not authorized? The fix doesn't work? **When in doubt, get help.**
For example: guard or interlock work, an alarm you don't recognize, reaching into a mixer.

Your lead

Days	_____	**Radio or phone**	_____
Nights	_____	**No answer? Call**	_____
Weekends	_____	**Report catches to**	_____

This rule adds to your procedures, permits, lockout and guards. It never replaces them.